VICTORY 2026

HISTORY

Independence & Partition of India

Lecture 02

By – Kunal Sir



Topics *to be covered*

1. Lord Mountbatten



Ques

India got its independence on ____.

(a) 26 Jan 1950

(b) 15 Aug 1948

(c) 15 Aug 1947

(d) 26 Nov, 1949





LORD MOUNTBATTEN

For the purpose of taking necessary steps for the transfer of power to the Indians, Lord Wavell was recalled and Lord Mountbatten was appointed the new Viceroy. Lord Mountbatten assumed the office of the Viceroy and Governor-General in 1947. His immediate task was to restore peace among the two warring sections-the Congress and the League-both in his Executive Council, and in the country at large.

fighting



LORD MOUNTBATTEN

Lord Mountbatten found that it was difficult to solve the deadlock between the two parties. Mountbatten realised that the Cabinet Mission Plan was unworkable and a partition of India was inevitable. He, therefore, sought to effect the transfer of power without any delay.

→ Cannot be avoided



MOUNTBATTEN PLAN

Mountbatten put his plan for the partition of India before the 'big seven' leaders- Nehru, Patel, Kripalani, Jinnah, Liaquat, Nishtar and Baldev Singh. The Congress accepted the Plan and Jinnah undertook to do his utmost to make the Plan work. The Plan was announced on June 3, 1947. On the same day, Gandhi said 'I repeat that the division of India can only do harm to the country's future'.

MOUNTBATTEN PLAN

The main points of the Plan included the following:

1. **Partition:** The country would be divided into two Dominions, i.e. India and Pakistan.
2. **Relations between the two new Dominions:** It was for the two Dominions to decide what relations they would have with the British Commonwealth and with each other.





MOUNTBATTEN PLAN

3. **A Boundary Commission:** The Plan provided for the creation of a Boundary Commission to settle the boundaries of the two Dominions in case partition was decided upon.
4. **The Princely States:** As regards the Princely States, the treaties with them would come to an end. They would be free to associate themselves with either of the Dominions or to remain independent.



MOUNTBATTEN PLAN

5. **Bengal and Punjab:** The partition of Bengal and Punjab was proposed provided that the Legislative Assemblies of the two provinces decided in favour of partition.

6. **Sindh:** The Legislative Assembly of Sindh was to take its own decision at a special meeting.



MOUNTBATTEN PLAN

7. **North-West Frontier Province:** A plebiscite was to be held in the North-West Frontier Province to ascertain whether the people wanted to join India or Pakistan.

8. **The District of Sylhet:** The Muslim majority district of Sylhet was to decide by referendum whether it would join East Bengal or remain in Assam.

MOUNTBATTEN PLAN

9. Constituent Assembly:

The existing Constituent Assembly would continue to work, but the Constitution framed by it would not apply to Pakistan. A separate Constituent Assembly would be constituted for those parts of India which decided in favour of partition.





MOUNTBATTEN PLAN

10. **Transfer of Power:** The plan ended with a declaration that the transfer of power would take place not in June 1948 but much earlier than that. The British Parliament would pass an Act for the transfer of power before August 15, 1947.



ACCEPTANCE OF MOUNTBATTEN PLAN

The historic pronouncement was received with mixed feelings by the public. The nationalists deplored the Partition of India, while the Muslim League was not fully satisfied with the way Pakistan was divided, but it accepted the plan for partition.



ACCEPTANCE OF MOUNTBATTEN PLAN

All-India Congress Committee accepted the Mountbatten Plan because, according to Maulana Azad, the Congress had no other alternative. The reasons for finally accepting the Mountbatten Plan may be summarised as follows:



ACCEPTANCE OF MOUNTBATTEN PLAN

(i) The large-scale communal riots that engulfed the whole country convinced all that the only solution to the communal problem lay in the Partition of India. In the words of Sardar Patel, "Refusal of the demand for Pakistan will amount to dividing. the country into so many Pakistan's."



ACCEPTANCE OF MOUNTBATTEN PLAN

(ii) The League had joined the Interim Government to obstruct and not to cooperate. Experience of working with the League had convinced the Congress that it could not have a joint administration with the League.

(iii) The only alternative to Partition was a Federation with a weak Centre. A smaller India with a strong central authority was better than a bigger State with a weak Centre.



ACCEPTANCE OF MOUNTBATTEN PLAN

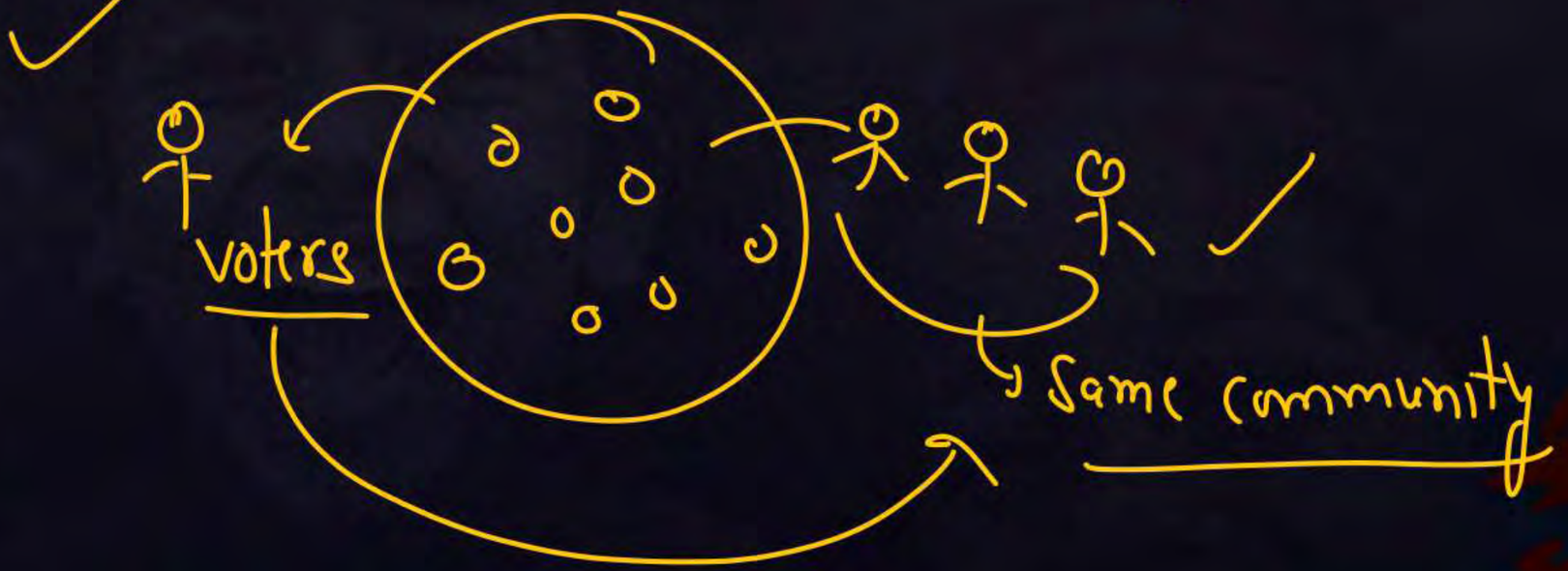
danger

(iv) Any further continuation of British rule would mean a greater calamity for India. The British were instigating the rulers of the Indian States to remain independent. Hence, partition was the price for immediate independence.

(v) The leaders felt that further delay in the transfer of power could find India in the midst of a Civil War.

ACCEPTANCE OF MOUNTBATTEN PLAN

(vi) The leaders felt that Partition would rid the Constitution of separate electorates and other undemocratic procedures. India could then evolve a truly secular and democratic polity.





THE INDIAN INDEPENDENCE ACT, 1947

After the Mountbatten Plan was accepted by the Indian leaders, the British Prime Minister introduced the Indian Independence Bill in the House of Commons. The Indian Independence Act was given the Royal Assent on July 18, 1947. The main provisions of the Act were as follows:

↳ King / Monarchy

approval



1. Two New Dominions:

India would be partitioned and two independent Dominions-India and Pakistan-would be created from August 15, 1947. The Act provided legislative supremacy of both the Dominions. The territories of the two Dominions were divided in such terms that Pakistan would comprise Sindh, British Baluchistan, Northwest Frontier Province, the West Punjab and East Bengal. India was to comprise all the remaining territories included in the British India. The exact boundaries of the Dominions would be determined by a Boundary Commission.



2. Provisions of Partition:

It had the following provisions:

(i) Both Bengal and Punjab would be divided if so desired by the people. The Provincial Assemblies of the two parts would meet separately representing Hindu majority districts and Muslim majority districts and would decide through a majority vote whether they wanted the division of the province or not.



2. Provisions of Partition:

It had the following provisions:

(ii) A plebiscite would be held in Northwest Frontier Province (NWFP) as well as in Sylhet district (Muslim majority area) in East Bengal to determine whether they would like to join Pakistan or India. (Both these provinces joined West and East Pakistan respectively.)



3. Governor-General for Each Dominion:

There would be a Governor-General who would be appointed by the British King on the advice of the Cabinet of the concerned Dominion. This arrangement would work till the framing of the Constitutions.



4. Constituent Assemblies to Serve as Central Legislatures:

The Constituent Assemblies of both the dominions were to act as the Central Legislatures and would have full powers to make laws for their respective Dominion. They would act as sovereign bodies for legislative purposes.

govt

↳ complete authority

↳ law making



5. End of Jurisdiction of the British Parliament:

(i) The legislative authority of the British Parliament would cease from August 15, 1947.

(ii) Abolition of the use of the title, Emperor of India' by the British monarch.

(iii) Till the new Constitution was framed, each of the Dominions and all Provinces were to be governed in accordance with the Act of 1935.

5. End of Jurisdiction of the British Parliament:

(iv) The Governor-General was given the powers to modify or adopt the Government of India Act 1935 by March 31, 1948.

(v) The right of the King to veto laws was given up. This right was given to the Governor-General.

change

negative vote

oppose



6. Princely States:

The Princely States would become independent and all the powers exercised by the British authority were to be terminated. All treaties and agreements made by the British with reference to States would lapse from August 15, 1947. They would be free to associate themselves with either Dominion or to remain independent.



7. Treaties and Agreements:

With effect from August 15, 1947, His Majesty's Government would cease to have any responsibility for the Government of India. All treaties and agreements between the British government and the rulers of the Indian States or any authority in tribal areas would lapse. Agreements with the tribes of the Northwest Frontier Province were to be negotiated by the Dominion concerned.



8. Division of the Army and the Assets:

Provisions were made for the division of the Indian army between the two Dominions and steps were to be taken to share the assets and liabilities between the two Dominions.

↳ resources



9. Bringing the Act Into Operation:

The Governor-General was vested with necessary powers for bringing the Indian independence into effective operation.



10. Office of Secretary of State and Interest of Existing Officers:

Provisions were made for safeguarding the interests of the existing officers appointed by the Secretary of State. The office of the Secretary of State for India was abolished.



10. INDEPENDENCE BY AN ACT OF LEGISLATION

Referring to the Indian Independence Act (1947), the then Secretary of State for India remarked, "The bill is unique in the history of legislation of this country. Never before has such a large portion of the world population achieved complete independence through legislation."



10. INDEPENDENCE BY AN ACT OF LEGISLATION

The Act marked the end of the British rule in India. The Dominions of India and Pakistan came into existence on August 15, 1947. Lord Mountbatten on the request of Nehru continued as the Governor-General of India. Muhammad Ali Jinnah became the Governor-General of Pakistan.



10. INDEPENDENCE BY AN ACT OF LEGISLATION

Lord Mountbatten remained in office as Governor-General up to June 1948. C. Rajagopalachari succeeded him as the first and last Indian Governor-General.



10. INDEPENDENCE BY AN ACT OF LEGISLATION

India became a Republic on January 26, 1950. Dr. Rajendra Prasad took over as the first President of the Indian Republic and the Constituent Assembly became the Parliament of India under the transitional provisions of the new Constitution.

Ques

According to Mountbatten Plan ___ was not going to be a part of India.

(a) Bihar
(b) Bombay
(c) Madras
(d) Sindh → Correct

Qus

_____ was the British PM during India's independence

(a) Ramsay Macdonald

(b) Winston Churchill

(c) Clement Atlee

(d) Lord Mountbatten

Ques

Who among the following can be credited for keeping major parts of India integrated / united ?

(a) Dr. Rajendra Prasad

(b) Sardar Vallabhai Patel

(c) Mountbatten

(d) Clement Attlee

Ques

_____ party was in power in Britain when India got it's indepence

(a) Conservative

(b) Labour

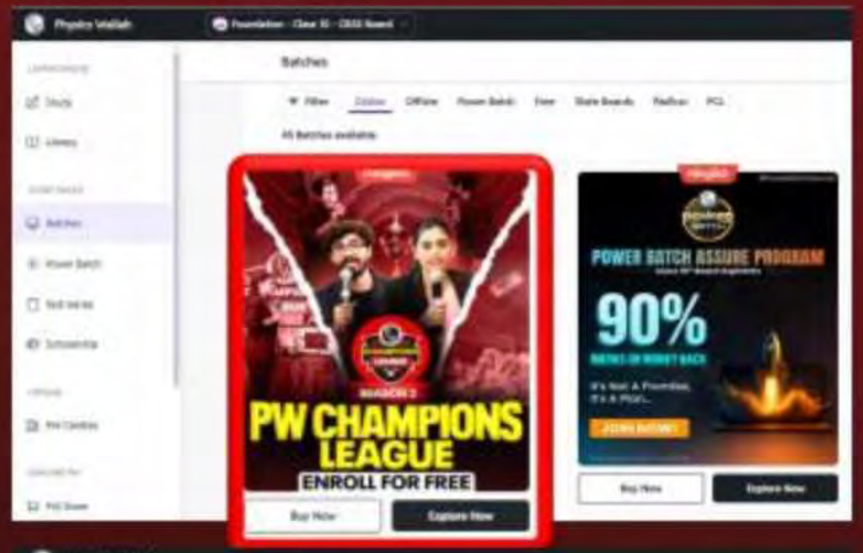
(c) BJP

(d) INC

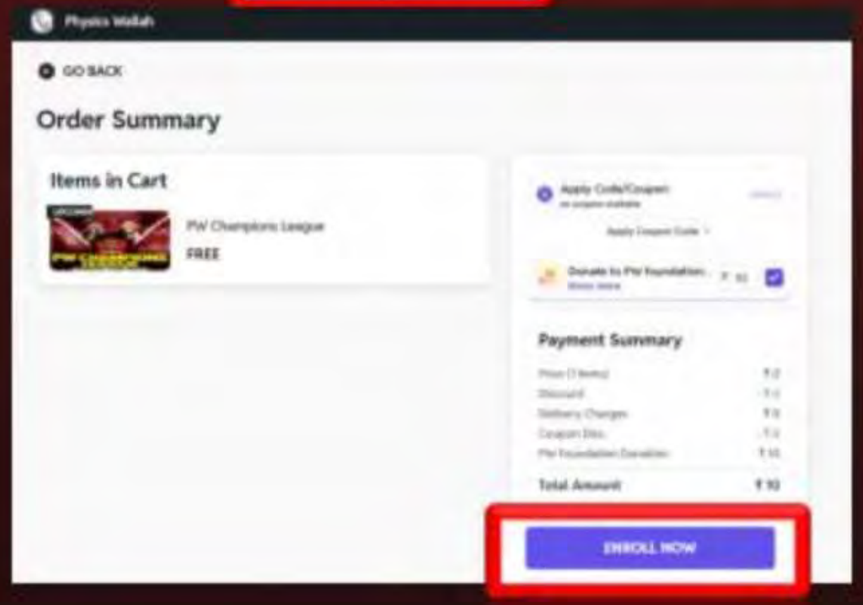

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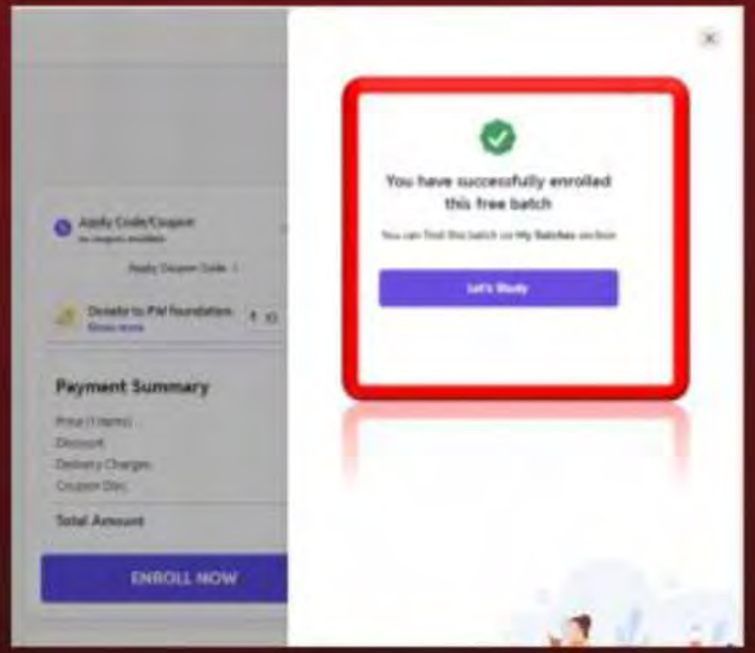
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